

Phil James Howson

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Professional Summary

Analytics and data engineering professional specializing in product analytics, predictive modeling, and cloud-based data systems. Experienced in designing ETL pipelines, experimentation frameworks, and statistical forecasting models to support business and pricing decisions across SaaS and eCommerce environments.

Core Skills

- **Conversion & Product Analytics:** Funnel optimization, lifecycle metrics, retention/churn analysis, SaaS KPIs (ARR, LTV, CAC)
- **Experimentation & Insights:** A/B testing, cohort analysis, pricing & promotion optimization
- **Data & BI Tools:** SQL (advanced), Python, R, Power BI, Tableau, Excel, LookML
- **Data Engineering & Modeling:** ETL pipelines, dbt, Airflow, BigQuery, AWS, GCP
- **Soft Skills:** Stakeholder communication, metric definition, cross-functional collaboration

Professional Experience

Freelance Data Analytics Engineer | AstraFY | 06.2026 – 07.2026

Client: Cartier

- Designed and implemented a reusable time intelligence framework in Looker, enabling side-by-side comparison of custom date ranges and prior periods for business reporting
- Resolved 15+ issues across dbt models and Looker, improving data quality, reliability, and accuracy
- Optimized BigQuery SQL for new data pipeline functionality, improving query performance

Freelance Data Analyst | GARI Enterprises | 04.2026 – 06.2026

- Built and deployed automated news scraping pipeline, implemented on Microsoft Azure for scalable data ingestion, processing, and execution
- Built an event model to classify the severity and risk of individual events and evaluate global risk

Freelance Data Analyst | Berliner Institut für Innovationsforschung | 04.2025 – 07.2025

- Developed automated ETL pipelines processing 500k+ multilingual records, reducing processing times by 50%
- Analyzed customer sentiment and behavior to inform pricing strategies and promotional campaigns
- Integrated structured and unstructured data to support strategic business planning
- Presented insights to stakeholders, translating complex datasets into actionable recommendations

Data Analyst | LMU München | 03.2023 – 08.2024

- Optimized data pipelines to reduce retrieval time by 30%, improving web analytics efficiency
- Developed predictive models and analytical tools to forecast performance and support growth
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to implement data-driven insights, improving decision-making clarity

Project Manager & Data Analyst | Leibniz-ZAS | 09.2021 – 03.2023

- Built scalable data pipelines, increasing workflow efficiency by 30%
- Developed statistical models to analyze user behavior and trends, informing product and engagement strategies
- Acted as liaison between technical and non-technical teams, ensuring insights were accessible and actionable, ensuring stakeholders can drive data-driven policy change

Education & Certification

- Data Science & MLOps Certificate: Université de Paris, Sorbonne (2024 – 2025)
- PhD Linguistics: University of Toronto
Focus: applied statistical modeling, machine learning, and large-scale data analysis
- German Language (B2): Iberika (2025)